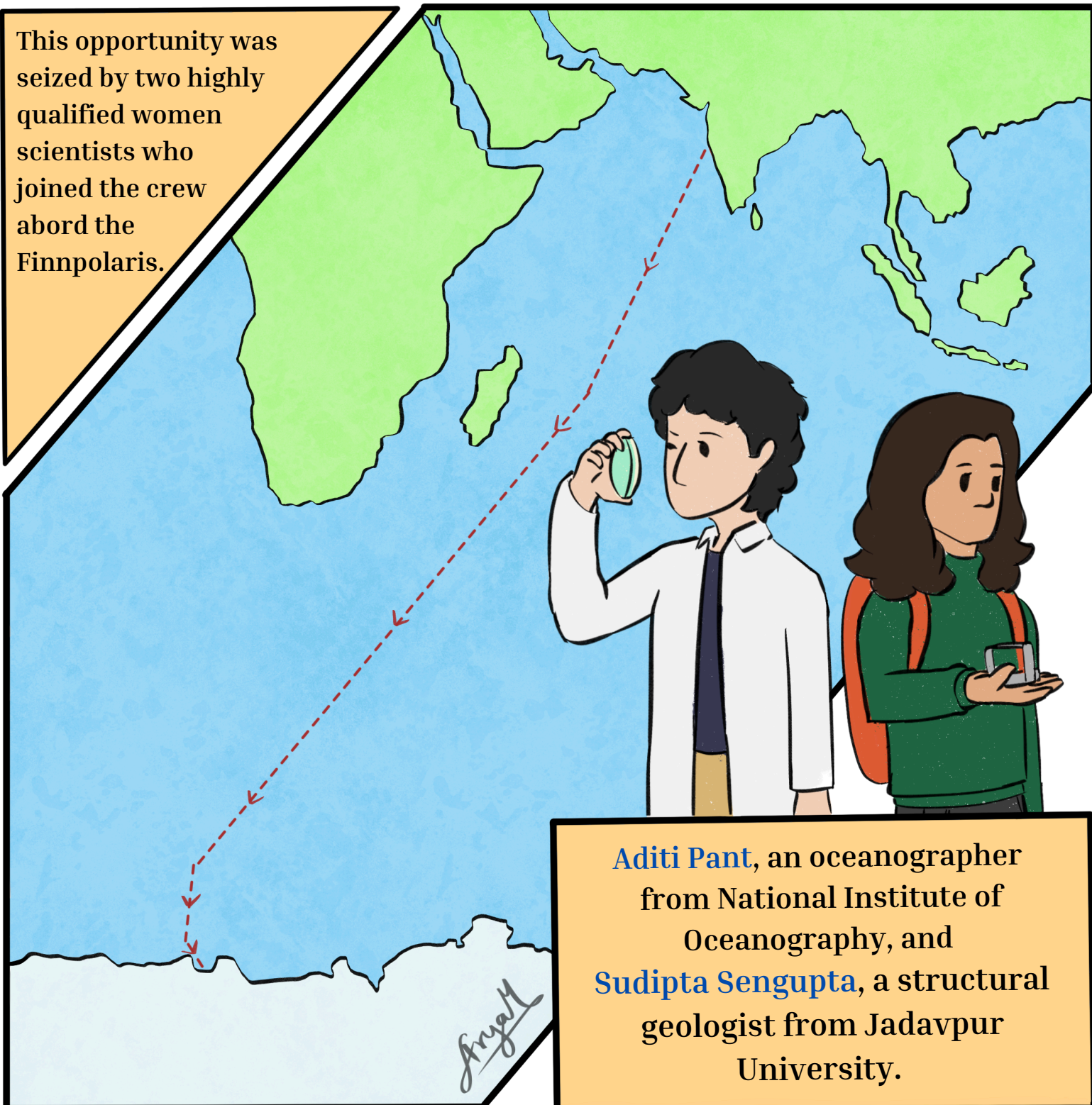




India's 1st Antarctic expedition was initiated by Prime minister Indira Gandhi in 1981. Women were allowed to join for the first time in 1983, for the 3rd Antarctic expedition.

This opportunity was seized by two highly qualified women scientists who joined the crew aboard the Finnpolaris.



Aditi Pant, an oceanographer from National Institute of Oceanography, and **Sudipta Sengupta**, a structural geologist from Jadavpur University.